

Copying & Moving Files

To copy or move files, just select the files and drag them from one window to another (or to a disk or folder icon). If you drag the icons to a different disk, the files will be copied to the target disk (the original copies will remain intact on the source disk). If you drag the icons to a different folder on the same disk (or to the disk's main directory) the files will be moved to the new location.

If you drag a folder, everything in the folder (including any folders and their contents, even folders inside folders inside folders) will be copied or moved.

Here's an example. Let's assume that we've received some fonts we want to install on our hard drive. The Fonts folder is inside the System folder on our Q Drive; the name of the Q Drive's first partition is Q1. The new fonts themselves are in the main directory of a 3.5" disk and are the only files on the disk.

We'll start with all windows closed. Next, we'll open our Q Drive's Q1 icon (double-click) and tunnel into the System folder (hold down Option while double-clicking the System folder). We'll locate the Fonts folder by scrolling the window until it is visible.

Now we'll open the 3.5" disk containing the fonts we want to install. We may need to position our windows so they don't overlap too much—we need to be able to see the Fonts folder in the System window so we can drag the new fonts into it. Next we'll bring the window containing our new fonts to the front by clicking in it once, then select all files by pressing ⌘-A. Finally, we'll drag the font files to the Fonts folder on our Q Drive, making sure that the pointer is directly on the Fonts folder and that the Fonts folder is blackened before releasing the mouse button. (If the Fonts folder isn't black, the Finder will copy the fonts into the System folder.) We release the mouse button and copying begins.

If some of the fonts we're copying are already in the Fonts folder on our hard drive, the Finder will give us the choice of replacing them or skipping over duplicate items. We'll probably click "Skip" under All, since we'd just be wasting time copying those fonts.

➡ **Shortcut**

To specify in advance how you want the Finder to handle items that already exist in the target directory, hold down the Option key as you drag the files. The Alternatives dialog has buttons that allow you to resolve duplicates on a case-by-case basis or to replace all or no duplicates.

Yes, it really is that simple. We could have opened the Fonts folder and dragged the new fonts into the Fonts window—remember, the window and the folder it is linked to are, essentially, the same thing. If the files we were copying were in a folder on the 3.5" disk, we would have tunneled into that folder after opening the disk—the rest of the procedure would be the same.

Here's another example, this time focusing on moving (not copying) files. Let's assume we've got some AppleWorks documents in our hard drive's main directory that belong in a folder. The folder is called AW.Files and is inside the AppleWorks folder, which is in the hard drive's main directory, Q1. As before, we'll start with all windows closed.